Objectives

1. To establish and maintain cardiopulmonary functions.
2. To maintain body temperature.
3. To avoid infections.
4. For satisfactory feeding regime.
5. For early detection and treatment of congenital and acquired disorders.

6.4.1 Nursing care of healthy new born baby includes

I Immediate care

II Routine care

I. Immediate Care

Immediate basic care of neonates at birth includes maintenance of temperature, establishment of airway, initiation of breathing and maintenance of circulation.

1. Clearing the Airway

As majority babies cry at birth and take spontaneous respiration. No resuscitation is required at birth for about 95 to 98% neonates. Establishment and maintenance of cardio respiratory function (ex. breathing) is the most important thing. The chest movement of the baby is primary and everything else is secondary.

Airways should be cleaned of mucus and other secretions by gentle suction

Resuscitation may require more active measures such as suction, application of oxygen mask, integration and assisted respiration.

2. Apgar Score

It is an useful quantitative assessment of neonates condition at birth, especially for the respiratory, circulatory and neurological status.

II. Daily routine Care of Neonates

- Warmth
- Care of umbilical cord
- Care of the eyes
- Care of the skin
- Breast feeding
- Baby bath
- Clothing
- General care
- Weight Recording
- Immunization

The major goal of nursing care of the new born, infant is to establish and maintain homeostasis.

1. Warmth

Warmth is provided by keeping the body dry and wrapping with adequate clothing. It can be placed in skin to skin contact with mother to maintain temperature. (Auxillary temp 36.5^0 C – 37.6^0C)

2. Care of Umbilical Cord

The umbilical cord is cut about 2-3 inches from the naval with aseptic precautions during delivery and tied with sterile cotton thread or disposable plastic clip. The cord must be inspected for infection.

3. Care of the Eyes

- Eyes should be cleaned with sterile cotton swabs soaked is sterile water or normal saline.
- Observe the eyes for redness, sticky discharge or excessive tearing for early detection of problems and for prompt management.

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